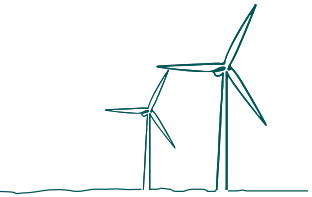
Global Ocean Accounts Partnership



Measuring and managing progress towards ocean sustainable development

The Global Ocean Accounts Partnership (GOAP) is **multistakeholder partnership** established to enable countries and other stakeholders to go Beyond GDP to measure and manage progress towards ocean sustainable development.

Co-Chaired by the United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific and Fisheries and Oceans Canada, **GOAP brings together governments, international organisations and research institutions** to build a global community of practice for ocean accounting.

Support available from GOAP

- **In-kind advisory and technical support** to secure funding for developing and implementing ocean accounting initiatives.
- **Collaboration** with GOAP members on development and implementation of ocean accounting initiatives.
- **Collaboration on the development** of knowledge products related to ocean accounting.
- **Policy development support** for ocean resources and the ocean economy.
- **Connection to experts and consultants** to host workshops and capacity building events to bridge knowledge gaps and develop technical expertise in-country.
- **Opportunities** to learn and share knowledge, challenges, and best practices on ocean accounting with global stakeholders and peers.

What we do

- **Accelerate and implement**
  the High Level Panel for a Sustainable Ocean Economy's commitments, SDG 14, targets 15.9 and 17.19 and other relevant international agendas.
- **Assist in sourcing financial or support**
  for the development and implementation of ocean accounting initiatives.
- **Catalyse and connect ocean accounts experts**
  to establish a Global Expert Panel to facilitate the creation of new knowledge to advance the development and global uptake of ocean accounting.
- **Provide a communication and collaboration platform**
  for the global community of practice to engage in mutual capacity development and share knowledge on ocean accounting.

GOAP

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What are ocean accounts?

Ocean accounts are **integrated records of regularly compiled and comparable data concerning ocean environment conditions** (e.g. extent/condition of mangroves), economic activity (e.g. sale of fish) and social conditions (e.g. coastal employment).

They align with existing international accounting standards and frameworks and retain a similar structure to national accounts maintained by national statistical offices or finance ministries.

Why ocean accounts matter

Ocean knowledge and data are fragmented across sectors and institutions and a lack of standardisation limits the ability to collate data in a coherent and transparent manner. This is where ocean accounts come in – **they provide an integrated foundation of information to inform evidence-based decision-making and holistic policy development for blue economy and sustainable ocean planning and management approaches.** By integrating multiple data sets from a range of sources into a common information infrastructure, ocean accounts enable countries and stakeholders to:

1. **Track the size**, condition and changing structure of the ocean economy.
2. **Re-enforce** evidence-based decision-making for ocean planning and management to balance the sustainable use of the marine ecosystem across multiple sectors and stakeholders.
3. **Activate** private sector financing in the ocean economy and ecosystem restoration projects.
4. **Identify** who is benefitting from the ocean economy (e.g. through ocean-related income, employment and welfare).
5. **Organise, present, and communicate** information in manner that decision-makers can easily understand (e.g. as dashboards or scenarios).
6. **Support and enhance** international reporting by identifying comparable, headline indicators that include environmental and social dimensions.

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